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Kleiner Perkins-backed Ambiq pops on IPO debut

Marina Temkin — 6:00 PM PDT · July 30, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: BLOOMBERG / CONTRIBUTOR / GETTY IMAGES

Ambiq Micro, a 15-year-old manufacturer of energy-efficient chips for wearable and medical devices, closed its first day of trading on Wednesday at $38.53 a share, a 61% increase from the $24 IPO price the company set the previous day.

The success of the IPO signals strong investor demand in the public market for new small-cap companies benefiting from AI innovation.

Ambiq closed its first day as a public company with a valuation of $656 million (excluding employee options). This represents a significant increase from its last private funding valuation of $450 million in 2023, according to PitchBook.

The company has pitched itself as well-positioned to capitalize on the growth driven by AI. “Because we’re so low energy, we can put more intelligence and more AI on board” of edge processors, the company’s CTO Scott Hanson told TechCrunch.

For the three months that ended March 31, Ambiq posted a net loss of $8.3 million against revenues of $15.7 million, the company’s S1 filing shows. The Q1 results mark a slight improvement from the first quarter of 2024, when the company reported a $9.8 million loss on $15.2 million in revenue.

Kleiner Perkins and EDB Investments, a Singaporean state-backed entity, are the largest outside backers of Ambiq, according to the filing.

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Wen Hsieh, who was a general partner at Kleiner Perkins until 2023, first backed Ambiq when the company raised its Series C in 2014. Hsieh also invested in Ambiq after he launched his own venture firm, Matter Venture Partners, two years ago.

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Marina Temkin

Reporter, Venture

Marina Temkin is a venture capital and startups reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining TechCrunch, she wrote abo...

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VENTURE

Kleiner Perkins is having a very good week

Julie Bort 3:04 PM PDT · August 1, 2025

Even while the tech industry is still fanning its face over Figma's hot IPO on Thursday, another significant tech IPO occurred this week: Ambiq Micro. On Wednesday, the chip maker for wearable devices saw its shares climb from the initial price of $24 to over $42 on Friday.

There's one thing both companies have in common: Kleiner Perkins was a major investor.

So it's been a very good week for the venerable venture firm. Just for fun, we've calculated the

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value of Kleiner Perkins' stake in each company.

Kleiner sold 1,346,499 shares of Figma at the IPO price of $33, Figma disclosed, and could have sold as many as 2,756,020 shares at that price if the bankers exercised their option to nab additional shares. Given how much demand outstripped supply for shares of Figma, we're going to assume the bankers will snap up the full tranche (or they already have).

Meanwhile, Kleiner still holds 52,364,374 shares of Figma, the company says. Share prices are still fluctuating wildly in heavy trading on Day 2, from about $110 to over $142, but closed Day 1 at $115, so we'll use that number.

For Figma: An estimated $91 million returned from share sales and a remaining stake worth more than $6 billion (2,756,02 shares at $33 = $90,948,660, and 52,364,374 shares at $115 = $6,021,903,010).

For perspective, this stake in Figma alone is worth 3x the last mega-funds the firm raised, which was $2 billion across two vehicles in 2024. By the way, the Kleiner partner who oversaw its investment was Figma board member Mamoon Hamid.

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Ambiq is a much smaller company and it was a much smaller IPO. It sold a total of 4 million shares and raised $96 million for itself in its IPO. Existing shareholders are subject to the classic 180 days lockup before they can sell. Kleiner holds 2,081,831 shares, the company disclosed. Shares are still trading at a premium to the IPO price as of Friday and closed Thursday at $43.85. So we'll use that price.

Ambiq stake: $91.3 million (2,081,831 at $43.85 = $91,288,289).

But wait! There's more. Kleiner is also having a good

Kleiner Perkins, with Ilya Fushman joining the board, the company announced this week. Bloomberg reported in December that Motive is gearing up for an IPO, potentially still in 2025.

Topics: Figma IPOs Kleiner Perkins TC Venture

Julie Bort
Venture Editor

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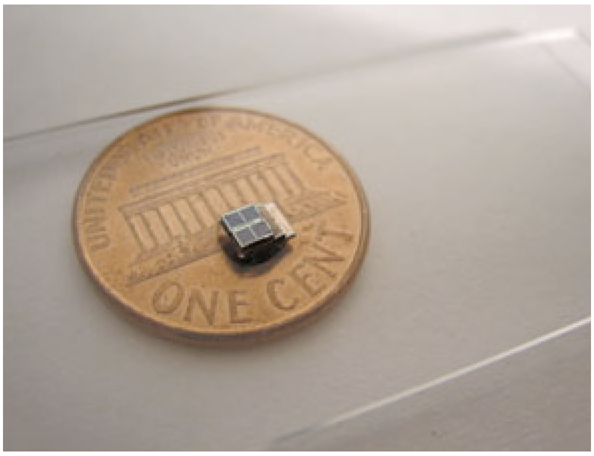
Ambiq Micro Closes $2.4 Million Seed Round For Efficient Micro-controllers

Lora Kolodny
12:58 PM PST · November 9, 2010

DFJ Mercury led a seed investment round of $2.4 million in Ambiq Micro, the companies announced



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today. Ambiq has designed and manufactures durable, highly efficient micro-controllers that can be used in everything from smoke and temperature sensors in smart buildings, to smart credit cards and smart phones.

The company was founded at the University of Michigan by Dennis Sylvester and David Blaauw, professors of electrical engineering and computer science at the University's College of Engineering, and Scott Hanson, a post-doctoral Fellow at the College of Engineering who is the company's chief executive.

Ambiq Micro practically swept the university business plan competition circuit in the 2009-2010 academic school year.

It won a $250,000 prize on July 1, 2010 from Draper Fisher Jurvetson (DFJ) and Cisco as part of a co-sponsored Global Business Plan Competition for university and business school students. Before that, Ambiq won the Pryor-Hale Award for Best Business as part of the Institute's Michigan Business Challenge in February 2009 and several others.

Ambiq Micro also attained a small (but undisclosed amount) of pre-seed financing from the University of Michigan's Frankel Commercialization Fund, the first student-led pre-seed investment fund in the United States.

Topics: ambiq micro Climate DFJ Mercury energy efficiency GreenTech Ned Hill Scott Hanson University of Michigan

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Lora Kolodny was emerging technologies editor and video host at TechCrunch.

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VENTURE

Matter Venture Partners raises $300M first fund to invest in 'hard tech'

Christine Hall — 7:00 AM PDT · March 28, 2024

Wen Hsieh and Haomiao Huang, both Kleiner Perkins investors, left the firm in 2023 to start their own venture capital fund called Matter Venture

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Partners. The firm had backing from Kleiner and Taiwanese chipmaker TSMC.

Hsieh was a longtime KPer, having been there for 17 years; Huang had been there four years. With a passion for what they call "hard tech," Hsieh invested in companies like microLED display technology company LuxVue, acquired by Apple; Amprius, which makes high-energy density lithium-ion batteries; drone maker DJI; and 3D printing company Desktop Metal, which went public via SPAC in 2020. Huang and Hsieh co-led investments in companies like the robotics company Dexterity and the CT scanning company Lumafield.

On Thursday, they announced the closing of a $300 million inaugural fund. Hsieh told TechCrunch it's considered one of the largest "first funds" raised in 2023. The median venture fund raised that year was around $37 million, according to a PitchBook-NVCA Venture Monitor report.

Matter Venture Partners was initially going for a $200 million fund, and Hsieh acknowledged that "it was a tough time for everybody" — startups and venture capitalists alike — to raise money in 2023.

"We had gone into it anticipating such difficulty and had very modest expectations," Hsieh said. "But to our surprise, it went really well for us. We closed $300 million last year, in its entirety, and were significantly oversubscribed."

Knowing when to say "when"

Figuring out the best amount to close the fund is a bit like being "Goldilocks," Hsieh said. Matter Venture Partners invests at the large seed rounds, Series A and Series B.

If a fund is undercapitalized, it may not be able to be competitive in deals or won't be able to support

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portfolio companies across several rounds, he explained. Overcapitalized and it may have too much money to deploy within a two- or three-year lifetime fund cycle. That could also lead to writing too many checks or sizes of checks that are too big for the appropriate fundraising.

WEN HSIEH, CO-FOUNDER OF MATTER VENTURE PARTNERS.

IMAGE CREDITS: MATTER VENTURE PARTNERS

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He believes that Matter Venture Partners' focus on hard tech was the reason for the oversubscription. "The world has realized that most if not many of the foundational technologies and trends of our society today are built on hard tech," he said. "That really puts wind behind ourselves. We came out successful and unscathed in a very positive way, and we're very lucky to have raised money at a tough time."

In addition to Kleiner LP and TSMC, individuals, entrepreneurs and family offices also back the fund. Hsieh, Huang and operating partner Mel Tang are also LPs in the fund.

Leveraging operating partners

Matter Venture Partners provides a unique aspect of having operating partners, which Hsieh said is typically something only larger firms have. One is Mel Tang, former CFO of video doorbell company Ring, which was later acquired by Amazon.

Tang has experience in operations, supply chain management and manufacturing unit economics, and Hsieh believes having expertise like this early-on in the life of a hard tech startup is a good value-add.

In terms of how Matter Venture Partners works with founders, the partners say they pride themselves on being company builders, but not at the expense of getting in the way of founders, Hsieh said. They like to be coaches, partners and jump in, all where appropriate.

All about hard tech

HAOMIAO HUANG, CO-FOUNDER OF MATTER VENTURE PARTNERS.

IMAGE CREDITS: MATTER VENTURE PARTNERS

They put "hard tech" into six buckets: semiconductors everywhere, robotization due to blue-collar labor shortage, generative AI, manufacturing on-shoring and friend-shoring, energy building blocks and life science automation.

"The common theme around these six areas is that we like to invest in the next 'picks and shovels' for all six of these trends," Hsieh said. "There are many gold rushes ongoing, but we would like to provide the 'picks and shovels' in every case. We like to fund them and entrepreneurs that contribute to these new innovations."

So far, Matter Venture Partners has invested in six companies not made public yet. It also doubled down on a few that came from the pair's Kleiner Perkins days, including Ambiq Micro, a company Hsieh described as "a key player in edge AI," which is a concept of more easily running AI workloads.

"It's all about low power," he said. "The big talk is about how much energy does it consume for inference, or how much energy for training? Ambiq is a world leader in making ultra-low-powered chips. They've dominated wearables, and now they're parlaying that into edge AI applications. The product is having a huge impact, and we're riding a new wave of energy-efficient AI awareness."

Ultimately, Matter Venture Partners will invest in between 15 and 20 companies with the new fund, Hsieh said.

Topics: Fundraising Haomiao Huang Kleiner Perkins Matter Venture Partners Startups Venture venture capital Wen Hsieh

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